4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: July 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

July 2026 Locked July 2026 is locked (closed 4 Aug 2026). These numbers won't change.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

July's jobs made $93,486 gross margin (43.4%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $26,391 and overheads $59,440, leaving $7,655 profit before tax (3.6% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.8% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$93,486
Technician wages and on-costs	$83,205
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$56,814
Technician time not charged to jobs	$26,391
Gross profit (the P&L)	$67,095
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,440
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$7,655
Revenue	$215,610
Gross margin on jobs, %	43.4%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.6%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**39.8%**

Line: All

July against July last year
3.4%
$215,610 against $208,588

Year to date against the same period last year
3.4%
$215,610 against $208,588

Gross margin, year to date
43.4%
$93,486 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 3.4% up on the same period last year, year to date ($215,610 against $208,588). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.9%); Installations the lowest (36.0%). The business needs 39.8% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 36.0% gross margin, 1.0 points over the 35.0% target ($1,430 ahead on $143,000 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($13,094 ahead on $45,350 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

July against July last year
21.9%
$45,350 against $37,200

Year to date against the same period last year
21.9%
$45,350 against $37,200

Gross margin, year to date
63.9%
$28,966 before overheads

What it shows
Maintenance contracts brought in $45,350 this financial year to date, 21.9% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 3.4%), at a 63.9% gross margin (above the 43.4% overall).

What you'd do about it
Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($13,094 ahead on $45,350 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

July against July last year
(6.0%)
$143,000 against $152,100

Year to date against the same period last year
(6.0%)
$143,000 against $152,100

Gross margin, year to date
36.0%
$51,480 before overheads

What it shows
Installations brought in $143,000 this financial year to date, (6.0%) on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 3.4%), at a 36.0% gross margin (below the 43.4% overall).

What you'd do about it
Installations: 36.0% gross margin, 1.0 points over the 35.0% target ($1,430 ahead on $143,000 this financial year to date).

Line: Call-outs and repairs

July against July last year
41.3%
$27,260 against $19,288

Year to date against the same period last year
41.3%
$27,260 against $19,288

Gross margin, year to date
47.8%
$13,040 before overheads

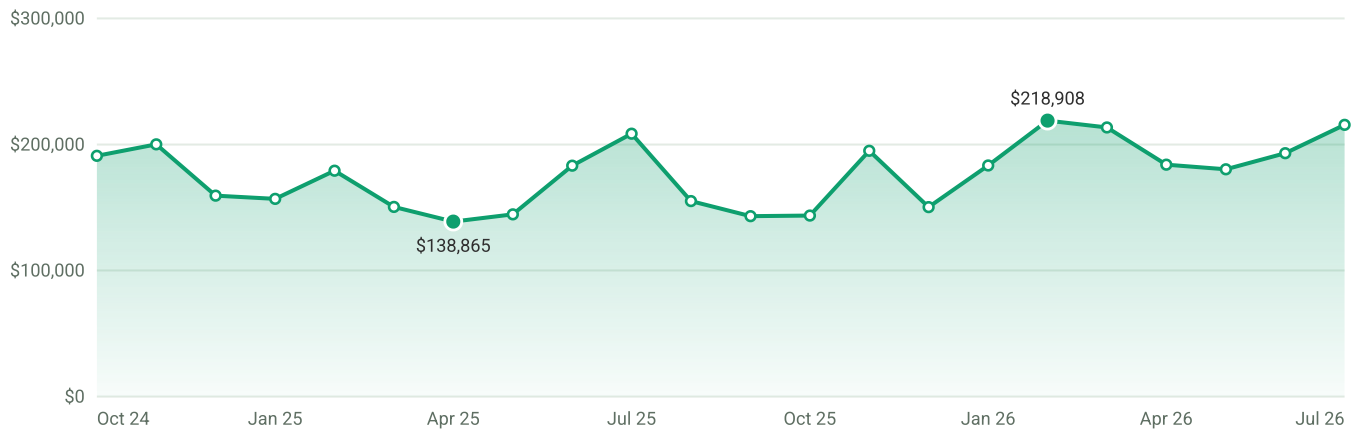
What it shows
Call-outs and repairs brought in $27,260 this financial year to date, 41.3% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 3.4%), at a 47.8% gross margin (above the 43.4% overall).

What you'd do about it
Call-outs and repairs: 47.8% gross margin, 12.8 points over the 35.0% target ($3,499 ahead on $27,260 this financial year to date).

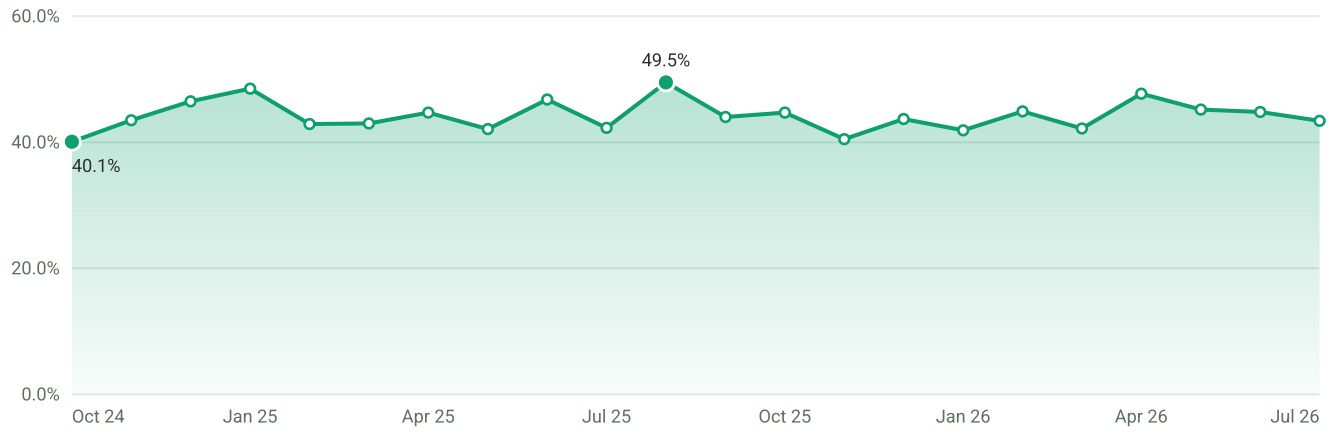
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$45,350	$37,200	21.9%	$28,966	63.9%
Installations	$143,000	$152,100	(6.0%)	$51,480	36.0%
Call-outs and repairs	$27,260	$19,288	41.3%	$13,040	47.8%
Total	$215,610	$208,588	3.4%	$93,486	43.4%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.